

Molecular Phylogeny of East African Dwarf Galagos (Galagidae; *Galagoides*)

Primate Conservation, Incorporate, Research grant #995

Applicants: Mr. Johan Karlsson and Professor Simon K. Bearder

Semi-annual Progress Report

Summary of project proposal

We proposed a survey of specific localities in the Biodiversity Hotspots of East Africa, including Eastern Arc Mountains, to collect genetic material from all known and all presumptive dwarf galago species. With a portfolio of newly compiled genetic data combined with described behavioral and morphological data we hope to settle the taxonomic status of dwarf galago populations. Furthermore, we aim to establish a complete record of their molecular phylogenetic relationships. Our findings will identify priority populations for conservation and management plans.

Research accomplishments

During the period May 25 – June 3, 2011, field research aimed to collect data on *Galagoides zanzibaricus* was conducted at Kiwengwa Forest, Zanzibar, S 6° 00.3', E 39° 22.7'. Kiwengwa Forest (KF from here on) is a mix mature, disturbed coral rag thicket surrounded by coastal villages, pasture and farm fields. Zanzibar is the type locality *G. zanzibaricus* and for *Otolemur garnetti*, which also was present at the research site.

Ten Chardonneret box traps were variably interspersed between twenty different trap locations in KF. A total of nine *Otolemur garnetti* (eight males; one female) and one *Galagoides zanzibaricus* (sex undetermined owing to its young age) were trapped. All but two *O. garnetti* was genetically and morphometrically sampled (two individuals were caught too close to dawn to allow time for sampling and safe release before sunrise).

Future activities

A preliminary plan to conduct remaining surveys is set to September 2012. Since one month will not be enough to conduct remaining fieldwork discussions are currently held within the research team (Prof. Simon Bearder, Mr. Andrew Perkin and Mr. Johan Karlsson) how to best proceed. PCI will be informed when a set time schedule for remaining work is decided.

Problems

The main reason that fieldwork sessions were not completed in due time according to time schedule set in the original proposal was due to administrative difficulties. When funding for the project first was secured, in March 2011 (from National Geographic Society), we applied to Tanzania Wildlife Research Institute (TAWIRI) for research permits. However, the application handling time was a minimum of 6 months. This made it impossible for us to proceed with our original plans. However, Zanzibar Wildlife Authorities work on a semi-autonomous basis from the mainland authorities allowing us to conduct this survey.

Unfortunately, we have had trouble obtaining CITES export permits from the Directory of Wildlife, Wildlife Division, Tanzania. There is currently an embargo put on CITES export permits. The reason is unclear. Meanwhile the genetic samples are stored in a freezer at Mr. Perkins residence in Dar es Salaam.

Financial report

The funds received by PCI have not yet been used in the project.

Solna, January 8, 2012



Mr. Johan Karlsson